



THE DIGITAL MALAWI ACCELERATION PROJECT

GRANT NUMBER:
PROJECT NUMBER:

IDA-E338-MW
P505095

Provision of a turnkey solution for the rehabilitation, upgrading, and commissioning of the Central Printing Facility including design, supply, installation and handover for full operational readiness

We received request for clarifications regarding the above captioned procurement activity and in the spirit of fairness and transparency, the clarifications together with the questions are shared in the Table below.

Table 1: Responses to Queries: 05

Sections of the RFB	Question	Response
§VII 3.4	Please confirm that the two million cards are blank card bodies carrying the card-body security features specified at §3.4.2 and §3.4.3 and no cardholder data. Please confirm separately whether the cards are to be serialized at manufacture and, if so, state the numbering scheme, format and range.	Two million cards are blank card bodies carrying the card-body security features specified at §3.4.2 and §3.4.3 and no cardholder data. Cards must be serialized during manufacture under a numbering scheme, format, and range proposed by the Supplier and approved by the Purchaser.
§VII 3.4; Impl. Schedule	Are the 2,000,000 cards delivered in one consignment or against a call-off schedule? State the secure blank card storage capacity available at the CPF.	A total of 2,000,000 cards must be completely delivered within the active contract period. Full delivery must occur prior to the commissioning of the turnkey solution. The contractor is permitted to split the delivery into multiple shipments at scheduled intervals rather than a single bulk drop.
§VII 3.4.2, 3.4.3; §III 1.4 item 2	Does an approved card design exist? If so, may it be released to Proposers, and	The Supplier is expected to collaborate with the Purchaser to review and finalize the new

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	please provide the official artwork for the national flag, emblem and map.	Malawi ID card design on polycarbonate cards. This card design finalization must be done after the contract award prior to mass manufacturing.
§VII 3.3.4, 3.3.1	Carrier letter: state paper size and weight; whether stock is pre-printed with NRB branding and supplied by the Purchaser or plain stock printed by the system; whether a design exists; and whether stock supply is in the Contractor's scope and for what volume.	Bidders are advised that the design of the card will be finalized with the successful bidder as indicated above
§VII 3.3.9, 3.3.11; 2.1.4.8	Does the Postal Operator provide an API to manage the card delivery life cycle?	As no Postal Operator is currently designated, the Supplier shall be solely responsible for engaging and contracting with necessary Postal Operators.
§VII 3.3.10; 1.5.2.1.3	We note the response confirming that 2,000 cards per hour is the aggregate output of the two personalization machines. Please confirm the same aggregate basis applies to the 2,000 completed mailers per hour at §3.3.10, and state whether that rate is measured on single-card mailers or on the expected mix of one to four cards per letter.	The specification clearly states that a minimum of 2000 mailers per hour with the two machines. This is based on single-card mailers.
§VII 1.4.1.6; 1.5.2.2.3	State the required RTO and RPO. §VII 1.4.1.6 requires both to be "defined" but does not define them.	Based on the proposed disaster recovery system, the Supplier shall define and agree upon these requirements with the Purchaser
§VII 1.5.2.3.1	Concurrent users: is the design, licensing and stress-test target 20 or 100?	The specification states that minimum 10 to 20 concurrent users. Scalable architecture supporting up to 100 concurrent users without performance degradation
§VII 2.1.3.4, 2.1.3.5	Confirm whether an external API exists allowing the integration with NRIS. If yes, state the technology used and the number of endpoints.	The Purchaser shall develop and provide the NRIS API to integrate with the proposed system
§VII 1.3.1.2.2.1.4; 2.1.3.8	Does an NRB or Government disaster recovery facility exist? Is the Contractor to supply and equip a DR environment, or integrate with an existing one?	The Supplier shall be responsible for provisioning the necessary equipment at the existing NRB Disaster Recovery Site (DRS), as dictated by the proposed solution
§VII 1.6.11.4; 1.4.1.5	We note that the National Registration Bureau currently prints a digitally signed biometric QR code. Please confirm	The Supplier shall deliver and configure HSMs to integrate with the Government

Sections of the RFB	Question	Response
	whether the Contractor is to supply a new PKI and HSMs, or to integrate with existing Government signing infrastructure.	signing infrastructure, utilizing the PKI provided by Malawi e-Government.
§VII 1.6.8	SOC: is the Contractor to establish one for the CPF, integrate with an existing NRB or Government SOC, or provide monitoring as a service under recurrent costs?	The Supplier shall establish the SOC for the CPF, integrate it with the existing NRB SOC, and subsequently hand it over to the NRB.
§VII 1.6.10, 1.6.6, 1.6.11.2	Immutable backups are "recommended", next-generation firewalls "preferred" at §VII 1.6.6 but "required" at §VII 1.4.1.5. Are these required, and do they attract credit in the technical evaluation?	All minimum specifications provided will be treated as strict, non-negotiable baselines for the technical evaluation
§VII 1.3.1.2; System Inventory Table	Confirm that all servers, storage, network equipment, firewalls, security appliances and licenses required by the specified architecture are within the Contractor's scope, and whether any existing NRB data center capacity, virtualization platform or network is to be used instead. The Inventory Table has one consolidated line.	The procurement, configuration, and provisioning of all firewalls, security appliances, and associated licenses required by the architecture fall entirely within the Contractor's responsibility. The solution must be completely net-new and self-contained. No existing NRB resources within the data center can be utilized or shared.
§III pp57,64	Which scoring scale governs: the 4/2/0 scale at p.57, or the 0–4 scale at p.64 in which 2 denotes meeting the requirements?	Bidders are advised that 4/2/0 is the scoring scale to be used during evaluation. In this scale, 2 denotes that feature partially meets requirements or has gaps/limited evidence. Bidders should however note that the Technical Proposal scoring methodology on page 67 complements the 4/2/0 scoring as it provides clarity to evaluators.
Clause 1.4.1	“Experience under Information System contracts in the role of prime supplier, management contractor, JV member, or subcontractor for at least the last five (5) years prior to the applications submission deadline”. A partner with whom we wish to do a JV had their last Information System contract in 2017. Within the scope of this RFP, they are to primarily deal with the construction part, and not the IT	Bidders are advised that the experience of at least five (5) years means that the lowest duration of experience should be five (5) years and any period above five years is acceptable.

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	part. Our understanding is that “for at least the last five years” may refer to the minimum duration of experience, rather than restricting the experience to contracts completed within the preceding five-year period. In this case, a contract from 2017 would fulfill the mentioned requirement. Please advise	

It is our hope that the responses provided will assist in finalizing your proposal.

Kind Regards

IPDC Chairperson